



CITY OF POCA TELLO

JOB DESCRIPTION / CLASSIFICATION SPECIFICATION

Position Title:	WPC Lab Tech III				
Pay Grade:	G08		FLSA Status	Non-Exempt	
Department	Water Pollution Control		Supervised By:	Pretreatment / Laboratory Supervisor	
FTE:			Position #:		
Date Established:	8/2022	Date of Review:		Date of Revision:	07/2025

CLASSIFICATION SUMMARY

The WPC Pretreatment and Laboratory Technician III supports compliance with the Federal Clean Water Act and the success of the City of Pocatello Pretreatment Program. The position engages with business owners and operators throughout the city and is responsible for performing pretreatment inspections and administrative tasks to ensure commercial and industrial business are operating in accordance with federal, state and city regulations relating to discharges into the wastewater collection system. The position collects wastewater discharge from Significant Industrial Users (SIUs) for analysis to ensure compliance with City ordinances and state and federal wastewater regulations. The job implements the City's Sewer Use Ordinance along with Pretreatment Regulations and Sanitary Sewer Regulations and writes enforcement letters and compliance orders. The position responds to and investigates complaints and spills.

In addition to the pretreatment function, the position is responsible for performing a wide range of highly technical and specialized laboratory analyses using advanced instrumentation and data evaluation in support of the City's wastewater, environmental, and water utility operations. The job collects samples and performs laboratory testing and analysis on the City's wastewater treatment plant, industrial businesses, storm runoff, biosolids and the Portneuf River for compliance analysis and testing to ensure compliance with state, federal regulations and applicable standards. The position interprets laboratory data and IPDES permit regulations. The position participates in 24-hour sampling events pursuant to IPDES permit regulations. These events are scheduled to occur twice per year over a duration of one week during which time workhours are adjusted to accommodate sampling requirements.

The Pretreatment and Laboratory Technician III position requires an Associate's Degree or greater, a Pretreatment Facility Inspector Certification, and a State of Idaho Wastewater Laboratory Analyst Class III License. The position works under minimal supervision and requires substantial knowledge of pretreatment, environmental, sampling and testing regulations. The job requires specialized on-the-job training and continuing education in the wastewater, drinking water, and pretreatment fields. Error, omission or negligence in performance could have serious consequences to the plant process, public safety and the environment. This could lead to potential legal and financial liability due to non-compliance with federal and state requirements.

The job requires substantial knowledge of methods, equipment, materials, tools, IPDES permit regulations, and standard practices for sampling/testing of water quality, industrial and commercial waste discharges, and quality control/quality assurance requirements. The job includes maintaining an inspection database and



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30 associated records and logs, including compliance records, reports and correspondence. The job requires the
31 ability to create and maintain standard operating procedures, testing procedures, quality control reports, quality
32 assurance reports, operating charts, bench sheets/forms, and best management procedures for the lab. The
33 job also includes cleaning, calibrating, ordering and maintaining lab and sampling equipment.

34 The job requires specialized on-the-job training and continuing education in the wastewater, drinking water, and
35 pretreatment fields and provides training and direction to the Pretreatment and Laboratory Technician I and II.
36 Serves as a back-up to the Pretreatment and Laboratory Supervisor by assisting staff, the public and
37 businesses in the supervisor's absence.

38 The position participates in community education and outreach on wastewater pretreatment and related
39 environmental programs by developing educational materials and performing presentations at schools and
40 various outreach events.

41 The job requires the ability to maintain a collaborative and cooperative working relationship with elected and
42 appointed officials, other City employees, other organizations, business owners, industrial employees, and the
43 general public.

44 The work environment includes a wastewater treatment facility, office, laboratory, and a variety of field testing
45 and inspection environments, including rivers and industrial facilities. These work environments may include
46 protected exposure to infectious bacteria, bodily fluids, hazardous chemicals and gasses, wastewater
47 treatment equipment, noisy and/or loud equipment, hazardous or toxic waste material, adverse weather
48 conditions, high traffic areas, and the hazards involved in collection of water samples from rivers and industrial
49 facilities. The noise level is generally moderate.

50 **ESSENTIAL DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES** *(illustrative only and may vary by assignment)*

51 Performs monitoring and enforcement of the pretreatment program by collecting/analyzing commercial and
52 industrial wastewater samples. Conducts inspections, monitors and collects wastewater discharge, and
53 investigates complaints and spills to ensure the City remains in compliance with the Federal Clean Water Act
54 and other applicable City, state, and federal wastewater discharge statutes and requirements. Maintains legally
55 defensible inspection records and logs.

56 Responsible for issuing warning letters, reinforcement notices, and other enforcement referrals to the
57 Pretreatment/Laboratory Supervisor or WPC Superintendent. Assists in Show Cause Hearings, emergency shut
58 downs to protect public health and the environment, and gathering evidence and information for
59 noncompliance issues.

60 This position is also responsible for tracking permits and evaluating data and other reports to determine
61 compliance of permitted facilities.

62 Reviews new construction facility plans, preliminary engineering reports and specifications for new or modified
63 facilities. Performs sanitary sewer surveys and inspections for writing recommendations and findings.



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- 64 Collects and prepares samples from a variety of sources for laboratory analysis, ensuring proper handling and
65 chain of custody protocols are followed. Participates in periodic sampling events that take place over a 24-
66 hour period, which necessitates longer and variable shifts during the sampling event.
- 67 Performs laboratory testing on samples to ensure the City remains in compliance with the Federal Clean Water
68 Act and other applicable City, state, and federal wastewater discharge statutes and requirements. Performs
69 laboratory testing of treatment plant effluent and industrial and commercial wastewater, drinking water, storm
70 runoff, river, and biosolids.
- 71 Maintains legally defensible testing records, logs, databases and reports. Prepares periodic reports. Maintains
72 inventory of testing chemicals and reagents.
- 73 Researches and initiates new laboratory tests and writes new testing procedures according to approved
74 regulations.
- 75 Researches, reviews, evaluates and reports to supervisor updated information regarding monitoring practices
76 and procedures. Studies and recommends means to cost effectively improve monitoring and compliance
77 performance and implements upon approval.
- 78 Assists in pretreatment, drinking water and laboratory audits conducted by regulatory agencies to ensure the
79 City complies with all regulations.
- 80 Maintains the safety and hygiene of laboratory and other work spaces. Cleans, calibrates, troubleshoots and
81 performs preventative maintenance on laboratory sampling, testing and analysis equipment.
- 82 Creates and presents public programs on wastewater pretreatment and related environmental programs.
83 Prepares public education materials and conducts public outreach (examples would include information
84 meetings or workshops, brochures, fact sheets). Coordinates, supports, and participates in outreach events
85 such as classroom/school events, Water Week, Portneuf Environmental Fair, Drug Take-Back program and
86 STEM events.
- 87 Attends and completes assigned training as required to ensure compliance with City policy, state and federal
88 regulation, and maintain professional licensing and certification.
- 89 Performs all work duties and activities in accordance with City policies, procedures, and safety practices.
- 90 Performs other duties as assigned. Nothing in this job description restricts management's right to assign or
91 reassign duties and responsibilities to this position at any time.

92 **CLASSIFICATION REQUIREMENTS**



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The requirements listed below are representative of the minimum knowledge, skill, and/or ability required for an individual to satisfactorily perform each essential duty satisfactorily and be successful in the position.

Knowledge of:

- The Federal Clean Water Act and other applicable City, state, and federal wastewater discharge statutes and requirements and their objectives to ensure continued compliance;
- Methods, techniques, and objectives of performing commercial and industrial inspections, monitoring and testing wastewater discharge, and investigating complaints and spills;
- Methods, techniques, and objectives of collecting, preparing and testing samples for laboratory testing and analysis, including the procedures used in handling of field samples, the Chain of Custody process, and the proper precautions used when handling pathogenic and carcinogenic materials;
- Methods, techniques, and objectives of safety procedures during sampling and inspections for various industrial settings, rivers, high traffic areas, confined spaces, equipment, chemicals, and other environmental challenges;
- Laboratory testing requirements for the Quality Assurance/Quality Control program required by State/Federal certification;
- Data collection and recording methods, techniques, and objectives;
- Laboratory equipment maintenance methods and techniques;
- Federal, state, local, and other applicable statutes, codes, and regulations for wastewater testing and discharge;
- Federal regulations and City policies regarding safe work practices relating to use of equipment and power tools;
- Operation of basic office equipment;
- Operation of a personal computer and job-related software applications, including Laboratory Information Management Systems, Microsoft Office, Word and Excel.

Skill and Ability to:

- Interpret and effectively communicate information covering federal, state and local ordinances and regulations related to the Clean Water Act and other applicable City, state, and federal wastewater discharge statutes and requirements;
- Perform commercial and industrial business inspections, monitor and test wastewater discharge, and investigate complaints and spills;
- Perform field inspections, sampling, and laboratory testing of wastewater, drinking water, storm runoff, river, and biosolids;
- Initiate enforcement actions for non-compliance issues, including Notice of Violation letters, compliance orders, and follow-ups;
- Perform laboratory testing on samples to ensure the City remains in compliance with the Federal Clean Water Act and other applicable City, state, and federal wastewater discharge statutes and requirements;
- Prepare and analyze laboratory data required for the QA/QC program;
- Review and monitor laboratory equipment and procedures for tests to troubleshoot and resolve areas of concern;



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- Maintain detailed and accurate inspection and laboratory testing records and logs. Create and maintain database of permit, inspection, and testing information;
- Prepare clear and concise written reports, procedures and correspondence;
- Operate, troubleshoot and maintain laboratory sampling, testing, and analysis equipment;
- Create and present public programs on wastewater pretreatment and related environmental programs;
- Train and direct employees;
- Operate a motor vehicle;
- Operate a personal computer and job-related software applications;
- Maintain a professional demeanor at all times;
- Communicate effectively in the English language at a level necessary for efficient job performance;
- Complete assignments in a timely fashion; understand and comply with all rules, policies and regulations;
- Perform all duties in accordance with City policies and procedures with regard for personal safety and that of other employees and the public.

ACCEPTABLE EXPERIENCE, TRAINING, LICENSES AND/OR CERTIFICATIONS

- High school diploma or GED; and
- Associate's Degree in environmental sciences or a related field is required;
- State of Idaho Wastewater Laboratory Analyst III License is required;
- Pretreatment Facility Inspection Certification is required;
- Valid State of Idaho driver's license is required;
- Four years of laboratory and/or pretreatment experience required; a Bachelor's degree in environmental sciences or a related field may be substituted for two of the four required years of experience;
- An equivalent combination of education and experience that provides the required skills, knowledge and abilities to successfully perform the essential functions of the position may be considered.

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***Hiring Note:**

Employees who currently work in the WPC Pretreatment and Laboratory Technician II position may promote to the WPC Pretreatment and Laboratory Technician III position after meeting the experience/education and licensing/certification requirements.

PHYSICAL REQUIREMENTS *

While performing the duties of this classification, the employee is frequently required to stand, walk, sit, stoop, kneel, bend, and may work in confined spaces. The job requires hand/finger dexterity to keyboard or type, handle materials, manipulate tools, and reach with hands and arms. The job requires operation of job-related equipment and operating a vehicle. The employee must occasionally lift and/or move up to 50 pounds with assistance. Sufficient visual acuity and hearing capacity to perform the essential functions and interact with the public is required. The ability to work variable periods during a 24-hour shift, is required. Reasonable accommodations may be made to enable individuals with disabilities to perform the essential functions.



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Position Notes	
Historical Title;	
Historical Pay Grade:	17, H08
Clothing Allowance:	No
Safety Footwear Program:	Safety Toe
CDL Pool:	No
Tied to Other Positions:	No
CBA:	No
Project Codes:	
Job Specific Expectations on File	